

Household Chief of Staff

A quick guide to what it can do and how to talk to it — everything happens over email, no app or login required.

What this is

An assistant that tracks household chores and personal goals for you and everyone in your household, entirely by email. It keeps track of what's due, sends reminders on its own, and understands plain language, so you don't need to memorize any special commands.

Getting a response

Send a new email with the subject line exactly “chores” (nothing else in it), or simply reply to any email the assistant has already sent you — a reminder, or an earlier reply. Replying keeps the conversation in the same thread. Only email addresses that have already been set up with access will get a response.

Chores — what you can ask

Just describe what you want, for example:

- *“What's on my list?” / “What am I behind on?”*
- *“Add taking out the trash for me, every Thursday”*
- *“Mark the dishes done”*
- *“Delete the lawn mowing chore”*

Short exact commands work too, if you'd rather: “list”, “done 3”, “remove 3”. The numbers refer to your current list, so ask for “list” again first if it's been a while since you last saw one.

Goals — what you can ask

Describe a goal and the assistant will set it up with a plan and milestones for you:

- *“I want to start running, aiming for a 5k by spring”*
- *“How's my Spanish goal going?”*
- *“Mark milestone 2 done on my running goal”*
- *“Check in on me every 3 days”*

If more than one person in your household uses the assistant, goals are private by default — you'll only see and manage your own unless you specifically ask to see everyone's.

Asking about both at once

You can combine a chore and a goal in one email — for example, “mark the trash chore done and update my workout goal to on track.” When a request touches more than one thing, the assistant will first reply with a quick summary of what it's about to do and ask you to confirm: reply “yes” to go ahead, “no” to cancel, or tell it what to change.

Confirmations

Deleting a chore in plain language works the same way — rather than deleting it right away, the assistant proposes exactly what it would remove and waits for you to confirm before anything actually changes.

Automatic reminders

You don't need to ask for these — they arrive on their own:

- A daily digest of what's overdue, due, and done.
- Goal check-in emails on a regular schedule (weekly by default, unless a different cadence was set for a particular goal).

Good to know

- The assistant only responds to a fresh email with the subject “chores,” or a reply within a thread it already started — anything else is ignored.
- If a request is genuinely unclear, it will ask a clarifying question rather than guess.